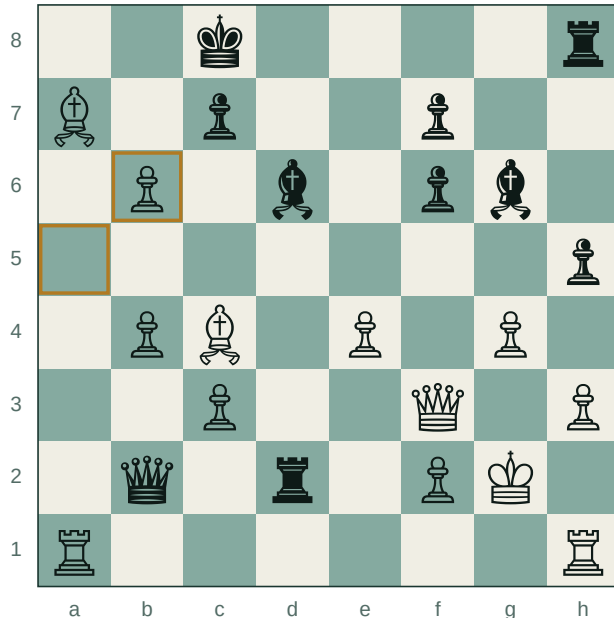


Interference tactics: Black, move 23

Interference tactics

Black to move



Previous move: 23.axb6. Gold borders mark its start and finish.

WORKED CONTINUATION - COVER THIS SECTION FIRST

23...Rxf2+ 24. Qxf2 Bxe4+ 25. Kg1 Qxa1+

23...Rxf2+ Check restricts White to 2 legal replies here. From f2 it attacks king on g2 and queen on f3. Recorded reply: **24.Qxf2**.

24...Bxe4+ Check restricts White to 2 legal replies here. The move also takes the pawn on e4. Recorded reply: **25.Kg1**.

25...Qxa1+ Check restricts White to 3 legal replies here. From a1 it attacks king on g1 and bishop on a7.

At the end, nominal material is White 25 / Black 24 (P=1, N/B=3, R=5, Q=9). Over this line, Black's balance changes by +2. Activity and king safety still affect the evaluation.

CHECKPOINT

Using P=1, N/B=3, R=5, Q=9, how much does Black's material balance change over the complete line? **Answer:** +2: the balance goes from -3 to -1. Count promotions and every recapture, not just the first gain.

CARRY THE IDEA INTO YOUR GAMES

Capturing the interposing piece may restore defense. Calculate which captures are legal and whether they permit another tactic.

WHAT THIS POSITION TEACHES

Interference interrupts a defensive line between enemy pieces. Occupying one square can make a previously protected target vulnerable or prevent an important recapture.

HOW TO LOOK

Trace the defender's line to its target and inspect forcing moves onto the intervening squares.

The defending king is on g2. Absolute pin: pawn on f2.